economies, etc., so as to catch up with our economic recovery.

We had an N.S.C meeting with our arms talks leaders looking at various options for how we wanted to deal with the Soviets. It's a very complicated business. I urged one decision on them—that we open the talks with a *concession*. Surprise! Since they have publicly stated they want to see nuclear weapons eliminated entirely, I told our people to open by saying we would accept their goal.

Nancy came to the Oval Office for lunch and we cut an anniversary cake and had a few of the immediate staff share in it. That was the extent of our celebration except that at dinner we opened a 1911 bottle of Chateau Margaux.

March 7

Lunch with Tip O'Neill. . . . Tip surprised me—he won't make an issue of MX but will not personally vote for it. He says it's a matter of conscience; having the MX he says will provoke a Russian nuclear attack. He can't respond when asked how we can remain defenseless and let the Soviets have thousands of missiles aimed at us. Big event was meeting with Politburo member Vladimir Shcherbitsky. He had Ambassador Dobrynin and a couple of others with him. I had George Shultz, Bud M, Don Regan and a couple of others with me. He and I went round and round. His was the usual diatribe that we are the destabilizing force, threatening them. It was almost a repeat of the Gromyko debate except that we got right down to arguing. I think he'll go home knowing that we are ready for negotiations but we d—m well aren't going to let our guard down or hold still while they continue to build up their offensive forces.

March 8